

Bloomberg Daily Briefing — May 28, 2026

US—Iran Conflict: Ceasefire Extension Reached

- **US and Iran agree to 60-day truce renewal, pending Trump signoff.** The tentative memorandum of understanding extends the ceasefire and opens further talks on Tehran's nuclear program. Treasury Secretary Bessent stated Trump "will not make a bad deal" and Iran must surrender highly enriched uranium and keep the Strait of Hormuz fully open. (Politics, via Axios)
 - **Markets rally on the news.** US stocks reversed earlier losses, oil pared gains, Treasuries rose, and the dollar fell against all major peers as risk appetite surged on the prospect of de-escalation after three months of war. (Markets)
 - **Oil pares war premium.** Crude pulled back from elevated levels as the ceasefire extension eased supply disruption fears that had driven an oil-fueled inflation surge across global economies. (Politics)
 - **Travel stocks soar.** Airlines and travel-related equities jumped sharply as oil prices dropped on the ceasefire headlines. Kayak CEO noted consumers are still booking trips despite geopolitical chaos. (Technology)
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Federal Reserve & Monetary Policy

- **Fed's Musalem: rate hike probability is "greater than zero."** The St. Louis Fed president warned the balance of risks has shifted toward inflation, said policy is "at or slightly below" neutral, and cautioned that the Fed cannot rely on an AI productivity boom to fix inflation. (Economics / Markets)
 - **New Fed Chair Warsh faces hawk containment challenge.** After winning the role partly on a rate-cut roadmap, Kevin Warsh now confronts a sudden hawkish pivot among policymakers as war-driven inflation simmers. (Economics)
 - **ECB hawks emerge.** An account of the ECB's April meeting revealed a number of officials wouldn't have opposed a rate hike. President Lagarde separately stressed central bank independence as "even more important" amid a challenging global order. (Economics)
 - **South Africa hikes rates for first time since 2023.** The SARB raised borrowing costs and signalled more tightening if the Iran war drags on, as producer inflation hit a record on war-linked fertilizer and energy costs. (Economics)
 - **Bank of Korea new governor signals hawkish shift.** Governor Shin Hyun Song cited financial stability concerns and Iran-driven inflation, underscoring more rate hikes to come despite holding rates steady today. (Economics)
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US Economy

- **Consumer spending under pressure.** US consumer spending crept up in April as war-driven inflation sapped incomes and pushed the saving rate to an almost four-year low. (Economics)
 - **Jobless claims tick up to 215,000.** Applications rose to the highest in a month but remain consistent with a stable labor market. (Economics)
 - **Mortgage rates rise to 6.53%.** The average 30-year fixed rate edged up after the biggest weekly jump since March, per Freddie Mac. (Economics)
 - **Defense orders surge to near-record.** US orders for defense capital goods hit the second-highest level on record in April, adding to signs the Iran war is boosting military hardware demand. (Markets)
 - **White House tightens grip on \$1 trillion in federal grants.** A far-reaching rewrite of federal grant rules would consolidate executive power over who receives federal financial assistance and how it's used. (Business)
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Markets & Wall Street

- **Citadel's Rubner: "pain trade" in equities points higher.** Scott Rubner argues the path of least resistance is up even after a double-digit surge in the past two months, as earnings estimates surge and AI spending acts as a counterweight to Iran headwinds. (Markets)
 - **Dollar falls, EM currencies jump on Iran deal report.** The greenback weakened against all major peers while emerging-market currencies rallied on the Axios ceasefire scoop. (Markets / Technology)
 - **Union Pacific—Norfolk Southern merger paused by regulator.** Shares of both railroads tumbled after the Surface Transportation Board paused its review of the planned \$72 billion deal, the biggest rail merger ever. (Markets)
 - **FTC probes fertilizer industry.** Chairman Ferguson confirmed an antitrust investigation into rising US fertilizer costs, adding regulatory risk to the agriculture supply chain. (Markets / Politics)
 - **Jefferies sued over "massive" water bond fraud.** Investors filed a class action over bond purchases in a water vending machine firm federal prosecutors have labelled a scam. (Markets)
 - **UBS family office clients cut US exposure.** Ultra-wealthy clients are reducing financial exposure to the US as part of a broader wealth management revamp amid shifting macroeconomic conditions. (Wealth)
 - **World's rich pocket \$1 billion selling surging stocks.** Super-wealthy individuals have offloaded more than \$1 billion in shares in recent weeks as markets repeatedly test new highs, taking cash off the table. (Wealth)
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Technology & AI

- **Anthropic raises at \$965 billion valuation, eclipsing OpenAI.** The \$65 billion funding round pushes Anthropic past its rival's valuation for the first time. The company also plans to widely release AI models with cybersecurity capabilities comparable to Mythos, which it previously deemed too dangerous for public release. (Technology)
- **Snowflake surges on Amazon deal.** Shares jumped the most since 2020 after the software maker signed a \$6 billion multiyear cloud agreement with Amazon and gave a stronger-than-expected annual outlook. CEO Ramaswamy highlighted AI-driven demand. (Technology)
- **Apple to overhaul Siri with AI in iOS 27.** A significant redesign includes personal data understanding, on-screen content analysis, and a new chatbot-style app. Expected to be unveiled at WWDC on June 8. (Technology)
- **Waymo deploys purpose-built robotaxi.** Alphabet's autonomous unit will offer public rides in California and Arizona with a new Zeekr-built vehicle designed specifically for driverless use — no human supervision. (Technology)
- **BYD debuts China's first automotive-grade 4nm chip.** The EV maker unveiled a series of self-driving technology advances, pushing deeper into vertical integration of the smart-driving stack. (Technology)
- **Microsoft partner IREN borrows \$3.6 billion for Nvidia chips.** The data center operator secured financing to provide AI computing capacity to Microsoft, highlighting the insatiable demand for AI infrastructure. (Markets)
- **EU plans €120 billion Chips Act reboot.** Brussels is making a fresh attempt to revive its semiconductor industry, targeting €120 billion in public-private investment by 2035. (Technology)
- **Goldman's Wheeler sees "generational opportunity" in AI infrastructure.** The global head of leverage finance said power demand for data centers will double within a few years and investors are focused on hard assets behind the AI buildout. (Technology)
- **Private credit snubs Thoma Bravo's Sophos on AI anxiety.** Lenders are balking at a \$2.5 billion refinancing for the cybersecurity firm as AI disruption fears chill software lending that was red-hot just last year. (Technology)
- **Prediction markets face insider trading scrutiny.** The multi-billion-dollar industry where users bet on everything from elections to military operations is drawing regulatory attention over insider trading concerns. (Technology)

Geopolitics

- **Europe weighs less reliance on US as Asia doubles down.** Tensions within NATO are pushing European nations toward collective defense independent of America, while Asian allies deepen US security ties. (Politics)

- **Sweden to sell and donate Gripen fighter jets to Ukraine.** Stockholm will sell 20 latest-model Saab jets and donate 16 older versions to support Kyiv against Russia. (Politics)
 - **Russia sells yuan bonds after Putin's Beijing visit.** Moscow issued its second yuan-denominated sovereign bond tranche following Putin's talks in China, deepening financial ties as Western sanctions persist. (Markets)
 - **Philippines and Japan move toward military intelligence-sharing deal.** President Marcos and PM Takaichi agreed to start talks, accelerating security cooperation amid shared concerns over an increasingly assertive China. (Economics)
 - **EU's six largest economies push capital markets union.** Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Netherlands, and Poland are advancing plans for bloc-wide capital markets integration after years of delay. (Politics)
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Corporate & Deals

- **Tilman Fertitta strikes \$5.7 billion all-cash deal for Caesars.** The years-long pursuit culminates in an acquisition that adds 52 US casinos to Fertitta's entertainment empire. (Markets / Technology)
 - **Delfin close to greenlighting first US floating LNG project.** The midstream company is nearing a final investment decision on what would be the first floating liquefied natural gas export site in the US. (Business)
 - **Apotex files for Canadian IPO.** The generic drugmaker disclosed a revenue jump in its Toronto listing filing. (Markets)
 - **Brazil's Petrobras hikes gasoline prices.** The state oil producer raised domestic prices after the government approved new subsidies to shield consumers from Iran war-driven crude increases. (Markets / Economics)
 - **Drone stocks surge on US funding hopes.** Shares of drone makers rallied on a report the Trump administration is exploring funding deals to boost domestic production and lower costs. (Markets)
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Commodities

- **Copper jumps to two-week high on Iran truce report.** The industrial metal rallied as de-escalation hopes eased supply chain disruption fears. (Markets)
 - **Gold advances as truce deal eases rate-hike bets.** Bullion edged higher on reduced expectations for aggressive Fed tightening following the ceasefire news. (Markets)
 - **Morgan Stanley: aluminum tightness could persist "for a long time."** Most smelters shut during the conflict are damaged, and restart timelines remain uncertain, keeping the market constrained. (Markets)
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Other Notable

- **Canada's Carney pitches closer US trade ties.** PM Mark Carney used a New York speech to argue for cooperation on aluminum, autos, and critical minerals — framed as helping "make America great again." (Economics)
- **UK youth unemployment crisis.** More than one million young people are out of work or training, risking a "lost generation" without government intervention. (Business)
- **Trump files fresh \$10 billion suit over WSJ Epstein story.** A new version of the libel lawsuit was filed after a judge tossed out the earlier complaint. (Politics)
- **Iceland overtakes Switzerland as world's most expensive country.** Trade union calculations show Iceland reclaiming the top spot for the first time in years. (Economics)
- **Venezuelans back dollarization.** More than half support adopting the US dollar to rein in a 600% inflation rate, per polling data. (Economics)
- **Private jet market shows no sign of distress.** Flight activity and jet orders continue to climb even as commercial airlines cut flights and vacationers pull back. (Business)

Sources: Bloomberg RSS feeds — Markets, Economics, Business, Politics, Technology, Wealth. All articles published May 28, 2026.

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